

A character who climbs down the ladder from area 4.3 to the corridor feels their legs suddenly falling out from under them, as their lower body is pulled toward area 6.8 while their upper body remains in the gravitation of face 4. The character must make a successful DC 13 Strength saving throw to hold onto the ladder rungs. On a failed save, the character falls and instantly whooshes down the corridor—whose gravity suddenly makes it an open shaft. The character takes 21 (6d6) bludgeoning damage from the 60-foot fall into area 6.8, lands prone, and is quickly surrounded by pixelated **merregon**[™] and pixelated **veteran** guards. See area 6.8 for more details.

If a character expects it, the gravity shift is easy to overcome by carefully climbing down one of the curved ladders onto the apparent ceiling of the corridor. This leaves the character clinging to the ladder going down, as the ceiling turns out to be one of the walls of the shaft.

AREA 4.4: JUNCTION ROOM

This door leads to a three-way junction whose shafts lead on to area 5.4 and area 6.4.

AREA 4.5: CORPSE FLOWER GARDEN

A **corpse flower** (detailed in *Mordenkainen's Tome of Foes*) grows here with nine bodies stuck in its tendrils. Spreading out around the flourishing flower is a carpet of juvenile plants: a thick mat of fleshy green leaves and tiny purple blossoms that reek of rotten flesh. This mat of greenery spills over the edge of the cube to area 1.2 on face 1.

The corpse flower attacks any living creatures that get close to it or attack it, and it moves slowly toward such creatures when it sees them. It routinely dispenses with its nine corpses to heal itself or send zombies against the characters, knowing that it has a near-unlimited supply of the dead beneath its roots. The corpse flower and the dead beneath it are always unpixelated, as the



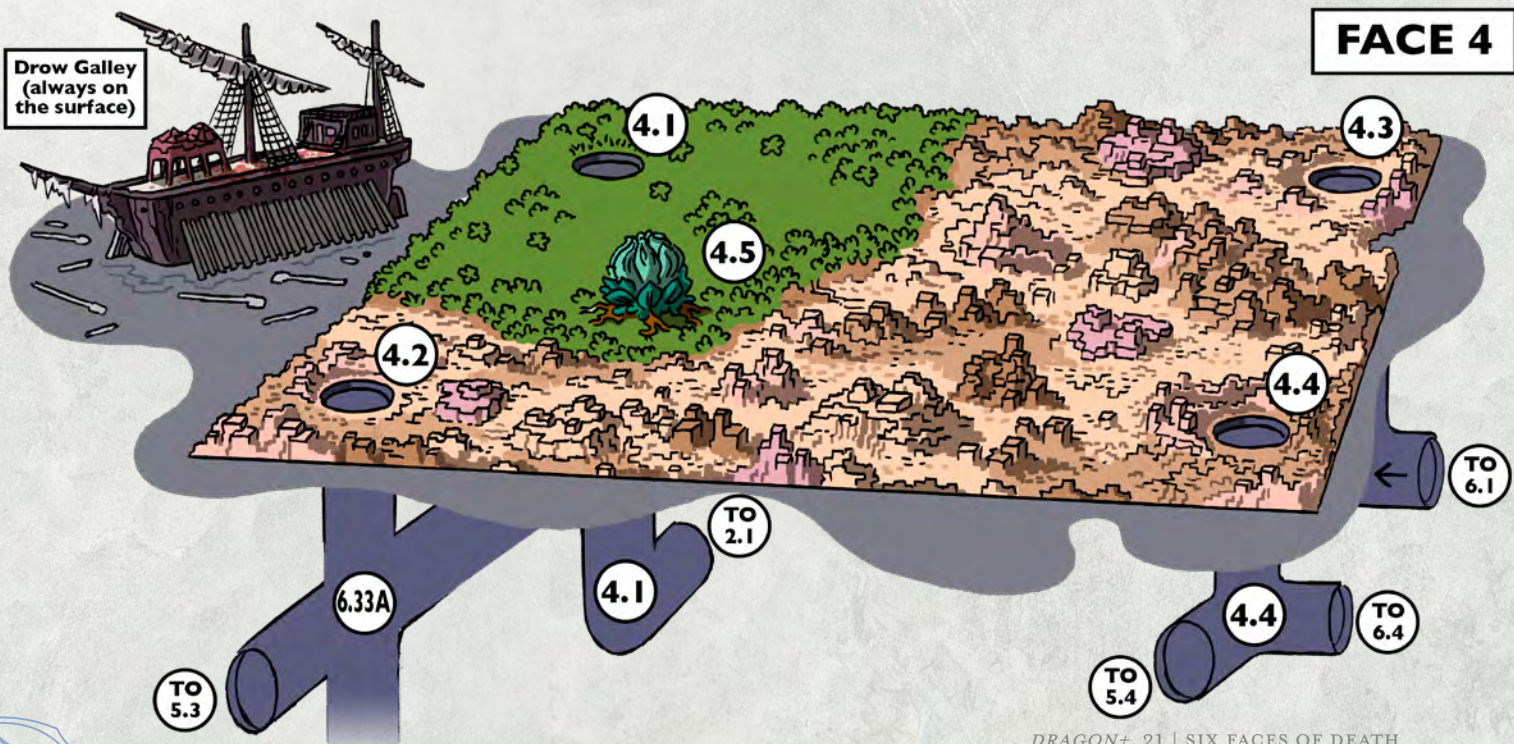
CORPSE FLOWER

Styx water the plant draws up through its roots washes through the bodies.

If the adventurers kill the corpse flower, they can dig beneath its roots, finding 1,200 gp, 400 sp, and a gold and jade death mask worth 900 gp.

FACE 5: BEAUTIFUL ISLAND

This face appears as a verdant tropical island. Sandy beaches open up to island grass and shrubs, beyond which spreads a jungle of banana plants, coconut palms,





and other trees. Gentle breezes blow here, and the gray fog that covers the island seems less oppressive than it does on other faces.

This vista seems entirely real. The sand and plants can be picked up, touched, and smelled, and even appear immune to the pixelating curse. But with closer investigation, characters might begin to spot cracks in this facade. No birds or animals can be heard or seen on the island. The breadfruit, bananas, and other seemingly edible plants are tasteless and provide no nutrition. The wood of the trees quickly begins to rot if cut, and the grass and shrubs will not burn.

Another giveaway as to the true nature of face 5 can be noted by characters who have visited the drow galley: the smell of the balhannoth. Any character who inspects the cargo hold of the drow ship and then comes to face 5 recognizes the same foul smell with a successful DC 15 Wisdom (Perception) check, and notes that smell growing stronger toward area 5.5. For the characters who don't recognize it, the smell is faintly bothersome but easy to ignore.

WARPED REALITY

The appearance of face 5 has been warped and reshaped by the balhannoth lairing under area 5.5. (See *Mordenkainen's Tome of Foes* for more

information about the balhannoth). The balhannoth can sense the presence of any creatures on face 5, and has been using its telepathy to sense the desires of all creatures within one mile of the island since it escaped its confinement on the drow ship. The appearance of the pleasant island has been created in response to the thoughts of the many sailors that have come to investigate the cube.

The balhannoth's hunting partner is the adult oblex that dwells at area 5.1, and which can take the form of living creatures that the balhannoth can't create. Unified by the conforming power of the pixelating curse, the two normally solitary creatures have formed a symbiotic relationship where they communicate telepathically and hunt prey together. When face 5 is submerged, they retreat beneath the doors until it surfaces again.

If the balhannoth dies, face 5 is slowly transformed back into its true form over 10 minutes—another wasteland of rock or bodies, depending on the state of its pixelation.

AREA 5.1: OBLEX DOOR AND GRAVITY SWITCH

The exterior door here opens to reveal an interior door 40 feet beyond. Past the interior door, gravity suddenly shifts to the orientation of face 6, and a shaft leads on to area 6.42. This shaft is filled with white and pink deposits of pixelated slime—the remains of the oblex's meals.

An **adult oblex**—a psychic ooze that can generate simulacra in the form of other creatures—uses this door to come and go. (See *Mordenkainen's Tome of Foes* for full details on the oblex.) The oblex can generate 1d4 + 1 simulacra resembling living creatures whose memories it has stolen. The number of creatures it managed to kill during the chaotic attacks that brought the cube to the Material Plane has given it a host of fiendish and humanoid forms it can take on.

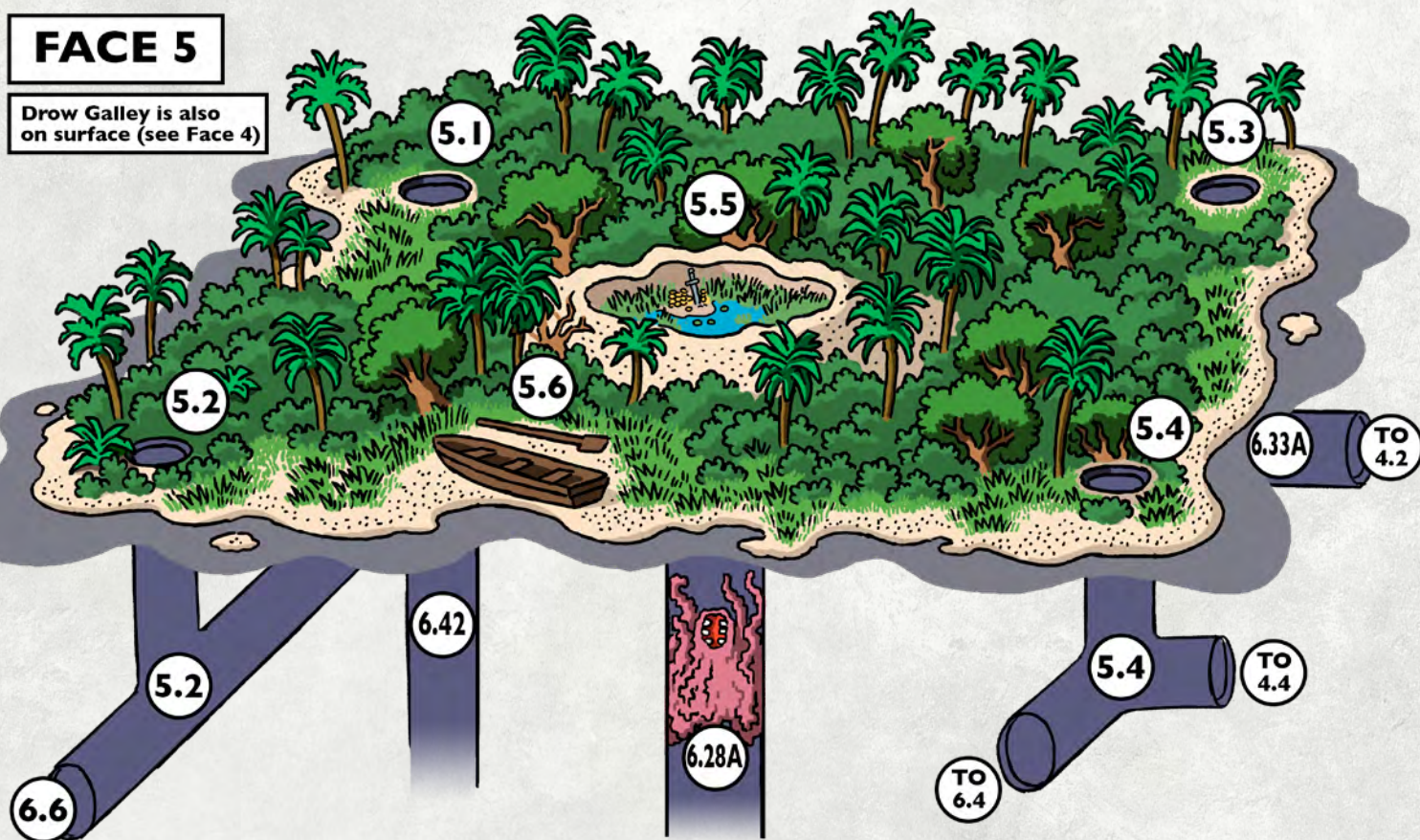
Creating simulacra of people needing aid or weak fiends just asking to be destroyed, the oblex sends those simulacra out of the jungle near area 5.1, while it stays concealed within the trees. (The oblex's true form is pixelated, resembling a large mass of pink and red jelly-like cubes. But it can create nonpixelated bodies to lure prey.) If only one or two characters are present, the oblex attacks through one of its simulacra at once. If more are present, it tries to get the group to split up, sending some to the pool at area 5.5 and encouraging others to descend through the door and head for areas 6.42 and 6.43, where its oblex spawn lie in wait.

A character who interacts with a simulacrum notices that it carries a faint scent of sulfur. A character might also notice the pixelated pink tether connecting the simulacrum to the oblex with a successful Wisdom (Perception) check opposed by the Oblex's Charisma (Deception) check.

Because the oblex is lawful, the door won't close on its tether if it and any of its simulacra are on opposite sides of it. If the door is held open in this way for more than a few minutes, the oblex either retreats down the shaft or slithers up onto the surface.

FACE 5

Drow Galley is also on surface (see Face 4)



AREA 5.2: INTERIOR DOOR AND GRAVITY SWITCH

The exterior door here opens to reveal an interior door 40 feet beyond. Past the interior door, gravity suddenly shifts to the orientation of face 6, and a short corridor leads to the junction space between area 6.6 and area 6.42.

Any creature moving toward this area through level 6 simply climbs along a ladder, passing the 'horizontal' ladder shaft to area 5.2 as they do. However, creatures descending from area 5.2 must carefully navigate a change in the cube's internal gravity.

Deadly Gravity. From the perspective of those coming from area 5.2, the shaft abruptly opens up in what appears to be the ceiling of a two-way corridor. Two of the four ladders leading down curve and run along the ceiling of this corridor, while the other two go halfway down the wall of the corridor before turning 90 degrees to the left and right. Looking down into the corridor, the characters see that the T corridor ends in another circular metal door (area 6.6) in one direction. In the other direction, the corridor continues a long distance into darkness.

Where the shaft from area 5.2 meets the shaft below, a shapeless red cubic mosaic stands out on the otherwise featureless black iron wall. If touched, some of it rubs off. If any character has *true seeing* or views the mosaic with *pixel glasses*, they see the pixelated mosaic in its true form as a message written in blood by a previous visitor. The message reads in Common: 'THE FLOOR BECOMES THE WALL! LOOK OUT!'

A character who climbs down the ladder from area 5.2 to the corridor feels their legs suddenly falling out from

under them, as their lower body is pulled toward area 6.42 while their upper body remains in the gravitation of face 5. The character must make a successful DC 13 Strength saving throw to hold onto the ladder rungs. On a failed save, the character falls and instantly whooshes down the corridor—whose gravity suddenly makes it an open shaft. The character falls nearly 600 feet to area 6.42, taking 20d6 bludgeoning damage.

If a character expects it, the gravity shift is easy to overcome by carefully climbing down one of the curved ladders onto the apparent ceiling of the corridor. This leaves the character clinging to the ladder going down, as the ceiling turns out to be one of the walls of the shaft.

AREA 5.3: SPECIAL JUNCTION ROOM

An interior door opens up 40 feet beyond the exterior door. Halfway between the exterior and interior doors, gravity suddenly shifts to the orientation of face 6. Beyond the interior door is area 6.33A.

AREA 5.4: JUNCTION ROOM

This three-way junction room leads to the doors at area 4.4 and area 6.4.

AREA 5.5: POOL

At the center of the false jungle, the ground plunges down beneath tall trees to form a crater containing a shallow pool of clear water 30 feet below its upper edge. It takes a successful DC 15 Strength (Athletics) check to climb down the crater without a rope. The pool is 3 feet deep, with lily pads on its surface and horsetails and grasses growing along the shore. A tempting pile of treasure is spread along the edge of the pool—873 gp,

10 opals (100 gp each), a gold bracelet (250 gp), a suit of drow-made +2 *leather armor*, and a brass incense burner covered with fiendish symbols—a *censer of blood*. (See the “New Magic Item” appendix for more information on the *censer of blood*. Originally carried by the oinoloth now a prisoner in area 6.11A, the censer was lost here in the frenzied fight when the yugoloths were attacked by the balhannoth. That creature has no idea of the censer’s power.)

When not transformed by the balhannoth, the inside of the crater is a metal shaft with a spiral ramp carved along its sides, and which ends in a 20-foot-wide door identical to any of the other doors on or within the cube. But between this door and the interior door below waits the hungry **balhannoth** that has created face 5’s false island paradise.

Unseen Threats. The balhannoth is fully pixelated, appearing as a monstrous blob of cubes with four long, semicubic tentacles and a blind mouth of gnashing rectangular teeth. Its pixelated nature has bound its unnatural power to the cube, so that its blindsight and its lair actions extend beyond their normal range and across the full breadth of face 5. This makes the balhannoth aware of the movements of any creatures on the beautiful island. Though it is capable of hunting on the surface, it prefers to lure creatures down to the pool, whereupon it teleports to the top of the crater to leave prey trapped between it and the door.

The balhannoth can also simply teleport creatures under the door of this area, using its lair action. A deadly ambush predator, it lives to hunt and uses this method only rarely. But if the characters bring any NPCs onto face 5 with them, the balhannoth can pick them off this way, creating the impression of comrades simply vanishing into the jungle with no warning.

Being fully pixelated has made the balhannoth a servant of the skull lord. If the characters enter the cube without killing the balhannoth, the skull lord can telepathically summon the creature into the cube to help trap the characters in a specialized prison. See area 6.25 for more information.

Cannon Shaft. The exterior door at the bottom of the pool opens to reveal an interior door 40 feet beyond. The area between the two doors smells of rotten flesh and is littered with pixelated bones and rags from the balhannoth’s victims. Unlike most of the other shafts in the tube, there are no ladders in this shaft, and the walls are warm and streaked with strange colors. This is Cube 1717’s cannon shaft, which continues some 250 feet down into the heart of the cube (see area 6.28A).

AREA 5.6: FERRY

A few feet from the water along the edge of the beach lies a simple wooden boat that fits up to six people. A long wooden boating pole lies nearby. The boat is in fine condition and seaworthy, though it smells strongly of the Styx sea. Any character who inspects it closely can see that what first appeared to be natural lines in the wood are actually countless names carved into the boat’s plank surface. The boat radiates abjuration to a *detect magic* spell, and it is immune to fire, acid, cold, poison, and lightning damage. The pole radiates

conjunction to a *detect magic* spell, and is a magic item—the *merrenoloth’s oar*, described in the “New Magic Items” appendix.

This place is where the oinoloth and its guards made landfall on the island for the yugoloths’ ill-fated assault. The boat and the *merrenoloth’s oar* are both immune to the pixelating curse. With a successful DC 20 Intelligence (Arcana or Religion) check, a character inspecting the boat recalls the legends of the ferryboats of the River Styx, and can guess that the names scribed into the boat are, in fact, the names of the dead.

FACE 6: FACE OF EVIL

The surface of face 6 appears as a wasteland of rock or bodies with no notable features except its six doors. Though the characters have no way to note this from outside, this is the “master face” with which the cube’s internal gravity is aligned.

Many of the locations within this face are given both pixelated and unpixelated descriptions. The characters can see the latter if they use the *pixel glasses* or temporarily unpixelate part of the room with *dispel magic*, *remove curse*, or Styx water.

See “Running the Adventure,” earlier in this document, for guidelines on how to handle encounters with the defenders of the cube.

AREA 6.1: INTERIOR DOOR AND GRAVITY SWITCH

The exterior door here opens to reveal an interior door 40 feet beyond. Past the interior door, a side passage lined with ladders leads off to area 4.3, while the main shaft continues down 60 feet to the lighted room at area 6.8.

If characters coming down from area 6.1 try to walk into area 4.3, they find it unexpectedly difficult as gravity shifts, making area 4.3 appear to be above them. However, the effect is only disorienting—not potentially deadly as it is for characters coming from area 4.3 (see that area’s description for details).

AREA 6.2: INTERIOR DOOR

The exterior door here opens to reveal an interior door 40 feet beyond. Past the interior door, the shaft continues down another 60 feet to the lighted room at area 6.9.

AREA 6.3: JUNCTION ROOM

This door leads to a three-way junction room whose shafts lead on to area 2.2 and area 3.1. A set of *pixel glasses* (see the “New Magic Items” appendix) lie at the bottom of this shaft.

AREA 6.4: JUNCTION ROOM

This door leads to a three-way junction room whose shafts lead on to area 4.4 and area 5.4.

AREA 6.5: INTERIOR DOOR

The exterior door here opens to reveal an interior door 40 feet beyond. Past the interior door, the shaft continues down another 60 feet to the lighted room at area 6.10.

FACE 6

Drow Galley is also on surface (see Face 4)

